VolMarker user guide

Marking, publishing and monitoring FX and precious-metal vol surfaces · November 2026

VolMarker is the desk's shared tool for marking vol surfaces. It replaces the Excel marking sheets. Everyone works on the same set of pairs: what one trader publishes shows up on the others' screens within about a second, and is written straight to the Fenics and Front Arena files. Every version is kept, with its time, user and comment.

This guide walks through the screen from top to bottom, then covers event weights, pair settings, market data and alerts. The last section lists the settings in `config.json`, for whoever sets VolMarker up.

Contents

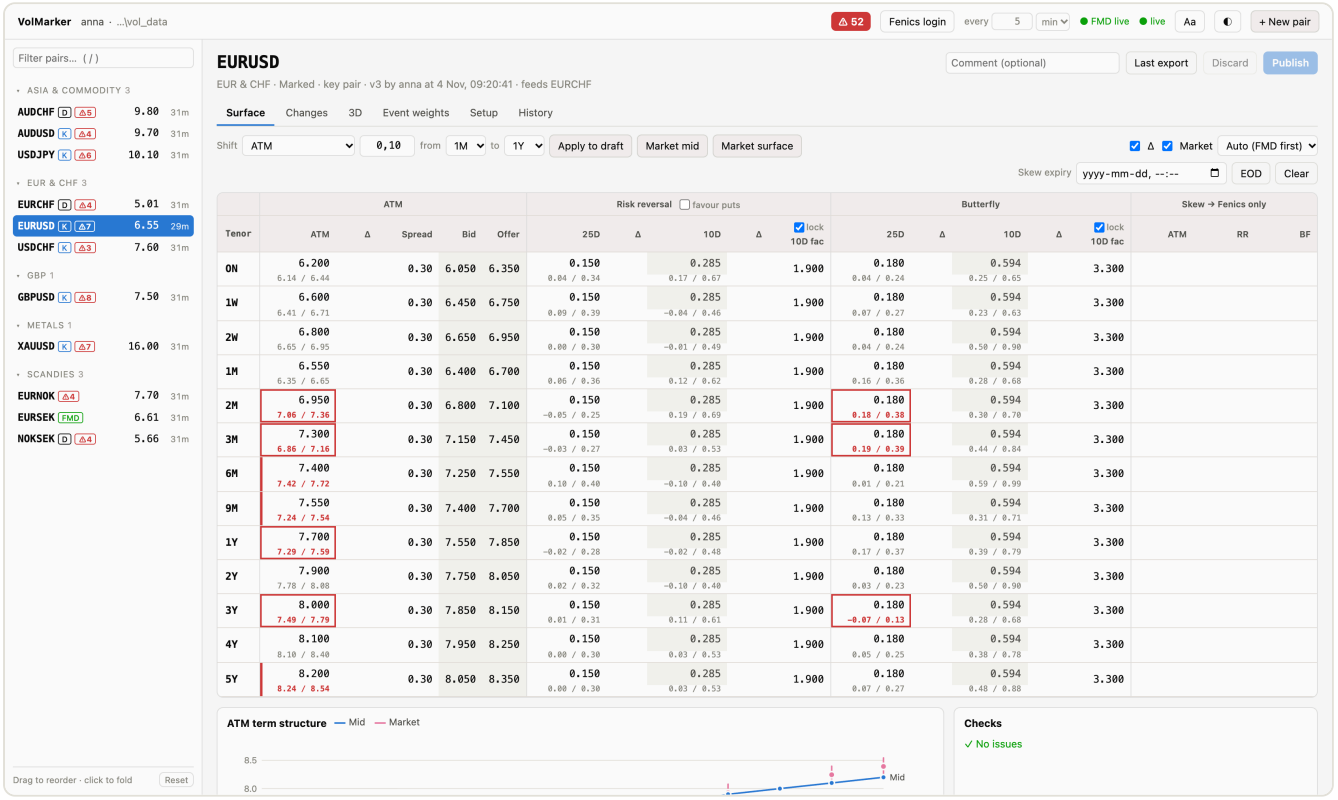
1. Starting VolMarker
2. The screen at a glance
3. The pair list
4. Marking a surface
5. Market data in the grid
6. Shifts, market levels and skew
7. Publishing
8. Derived, spread and following pairs
9. Changes, 3D and History
10. Event weights
11. The event calendar
12. Pair settings (Setup)
13. Market alerts
14. Fenics login and the FMD feed
15. Display settings
16. How expiry dates are worked out
17. Files, history and the leader app
18. Troubleshooting
19. Keyboard shortcuts
20. Settings for administrators

1. Starting VolMarker

Each trader runs VolMarker on their own PC. All copies point at the same shared data folder, which is how they share pairs, marks and settings.

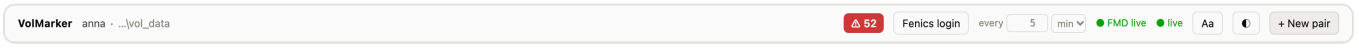
1. Double-click `VolMarker.bat` (or run `python -m volmarker --data "…\vol_data"`).
2. A browser tab opens at `http://127.0.0.1:18765`. Keep the small console window open while you work; closing it stops VolMarker.

2. The screen at a glance



The main screen: pair list on the left, the selected pair's surface on the right.

Top bar



Item	What it does
User · folder	Who you are logged in as and which shared data folder VolMarker uses.

Item	What it does
⚠ 50	Market alerts. Red while some are not acknowledged. Opens the alert panel (section 13).
Fenics login · every 5 min	Log in to Fenics to fetch FMD 1.0 vols, and how often (section 14).
● FMD live	The market data feed is running. *FMD off* means no market levels.
● live	Your connection to the shared folder. If it turns red, others' changes are not reaching you.
Aa	Text size, font and contrast for your PC only (section 15).
◐	Light or dark mode.
+ New pair	Adds a pair for the whole desk.

Pair header and tabs

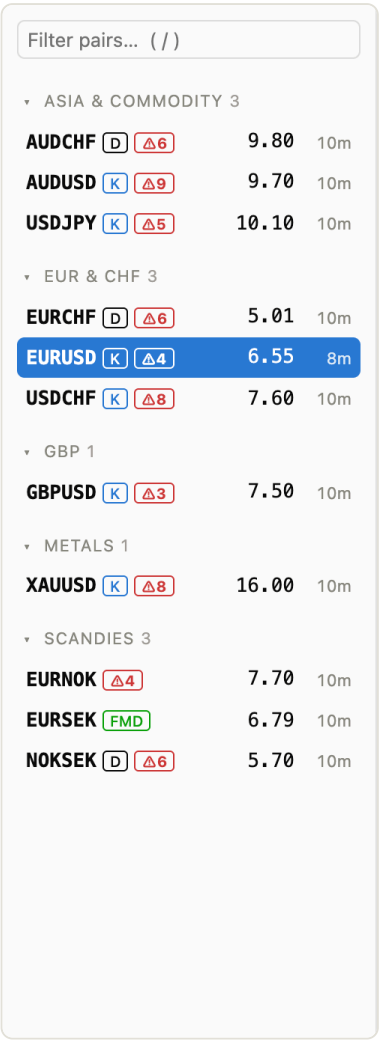


Under the pair's name you see its group, mode, the version on screen, who published it and when, and which pairs depend on it (*feeds EURCHF*). On the right are the comment field and the **Last export**, **Discard** and **Publish** buttons. The tabs below are:

Tab	Use it for
Surface	Marking: the grid, market levels, the ATM chart and checks.
Changes	Today's marks against an earlier day's end of day.
3D	The surface as a rotatable 3D picture.
Event weights	Day weights, events, test dates, dailies and the event calendar.
Setup	The pair's settings: mode, bases, cut, group, alerts and more.
History	Every published version, with a Restore button.

3. The pair list

Pairs are listed by group (EUR & CHF, Scandies, Metals, ...) with their 1M ATM and the time since the last publish. Click a pair to open it. Type in **Filter pairs...** (or press `/`) to find one quickly.



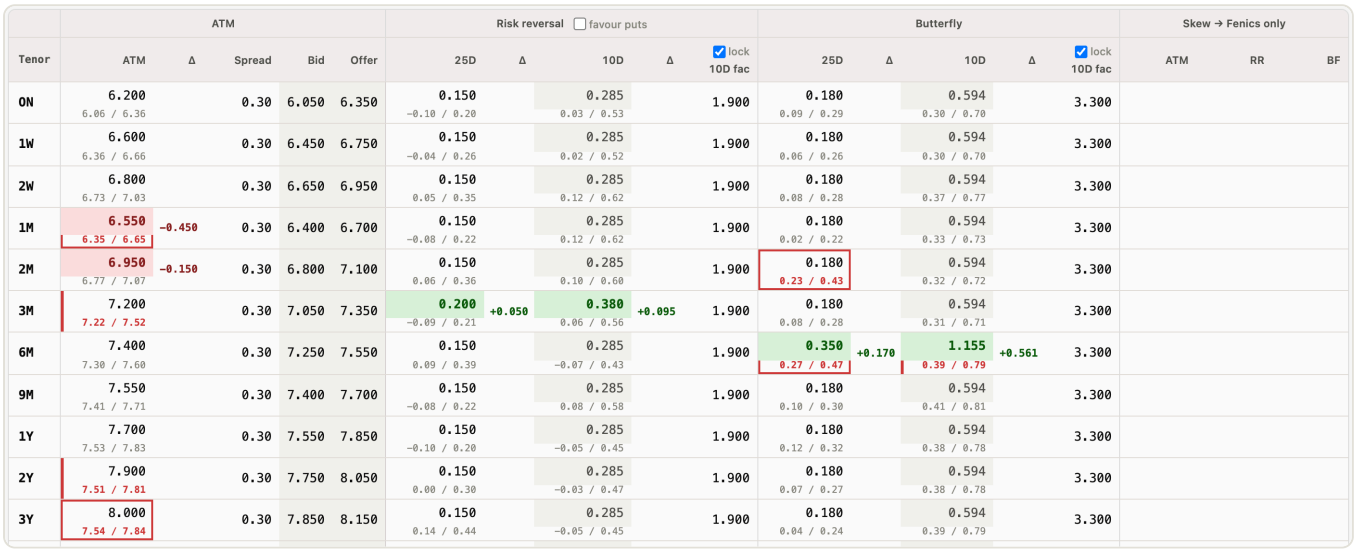
Tag	Meaning
`K`	Key pair: tighter staleness limit (2 hours instead of 24).
`D`	Derived from two base pairs through the correlation triangle.
`P`	Moves with a spread parent.
`FMD`	Follows the market: green ok, amber a move is being held, red not updating.
`XL`	Marked in Excel. Red: the last file couldn't be read. `XL?`: its file was changed outside VolMarker.
`skew`	A skew is active on the Fenics file.
`stale`	Not marked within its limit.
`!3`	Number of failed checks (e.g. calendar arbitrage).
`⚠4`	Open market alerts (grey once acknowledged).

The order is yours: drag groups, or pairs within a group, to rearrange them, and click a group header to fold it. A folded group still shows its stale and ⚠ counts. Your layout follows you to any PC. **Reset** at the bottom goes back to A–Z.

---

4. Marking a surface

The grid has one row per tenor (ON to 5Y, plus any extra tenors of the pair). For each tenor you mark the ATM, the 25D and 10D risk reversal and the 25D and 10D butterfly (broker strangles). The spread sets the Fenics ATM bid/offer around the mid. The grey **Bid** and **Offer** columns are what Fenics gets, including any skew.



	ATM					Risk reversal ☐ favour puts					Butterfly					Skew → Fenics only		
Tenor	ATM	Δ	Spread	Bid	Offer	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	ATM	RR	BF
ON	6.200 6.06 / 6.36		0.30	6.050	6.350	0.150 −0.10 / 0.20		0.285 0.03 / 0.53		1.900	0.180 0.09 / 0.29		0.594 0.30 / 0.70		3.300			
1W	6.600 6.36 / 6.66		0.30	6.450	6.750	0.150 −0.04 / 0.26		0.285 0.02 / 0.52		1.900	0.180 0.06 / 0.26		0.594 0.30 / 0.70		3.300			
2W	6.800 6.73 / 7.03		0.30	6.650	6.950	0.150 0.05 / 0.35		0.285 0.12 / 0.62		1.900	0.180 0.08 / 0.28		0.594 0.37 / 0.77		3.300			
1M	6.550 6.35 / 6.65	−0.450	0.30	6.400	6.700	0.150 −0.08 / 0.22		0.285 0.12 / 0.62		1.900	0.180 0.02 / 0.22		0.594 0.33 / 0.73		3.300			
2M	6.950 6.77 / 7.07	−0.150	0.30	6.800	7.100	0.150 0.06 / 0.36		0.285 0.10 / 0.60		1.900	0.180 0.23 / 0.43		0.594 0.32 / 0.72		3.300			
3M	7.200 7.22 / 7.52		0.30	7.050	7.350	0.200 −0.09 / 0.21	+0.050	0.380 0.06 / 0.56	+0.095	1.900	0.180 0.08 / 0.28		0.594 0.31 / 0.71		3.300			
6M	7.400 7.30 / 7.60		0.30	7.250	7.550	0.150 0.09 / 0.39		0.285 −0.07 / 0.43		1.900	0.350 0.27 / 0.47	+0.170	1.155 0.39 / 0.79	+0.561	3.300			
9M	7.550 7.41 / 7.71		0.30	7.400	7.700	0.150 −0.08 / 0.22		0.285 0.08 / 0.58		1.900	0.180 0.10 / 0.30		0.594 0.41 / 0.81		3.300			
1Y	7.700 7.53 / 7.83		0.30	7.550	7.850	0.150 −0.10 / 0.20		0.285 −0.05 / 0.45		1.900	0.180 0.12 / 0.32		0.594 0.38 / 0.78		3.300			
2Y	7.900 7.51 / 7.81		0.30	7.750	8.050	0.150 0.00 / 0.30		0.285 −0.03 / 0.47		1.900	0.180 0.07 / 0.27		0.594 0.38 / 0.78		3.300			
3Y	8.000 7.54 / 7.84		0.30	7.850	8.150	0.150 0.14 / 0.44		0.285 −0.05 / 0.45		1.900	0.180 0.04 / 0.24		0.594 0.39 / 0.79		3.300			

A draft with edits: 1M and 2M ATM lowered (red), 3M RR and 6M BF raised (green). The Δ columns show each change against the published value.

Editing

- Click a cell and type. Nothing is sent until you **Publish**; until then you are editing your own *draft*.
- `Enter`, `↓` and `↑` move between tenors; `Tab` moves across.
- `Esc` restores the value the cell had when you entered it. A second `Esc` goes back to the published value.
- Linked cells update as you type: the 10D quote or factor, the correlation on a derived pair, the spread to a parent.

Colours and the Δ columns

- **Green**: an ATM, RR or BF above the published value. **Red**: below it. **Yellow**: any other changed cell (spread, factor, skew).
- The **Δ** column next to ATM, 25D/10D RR and 25D/10D BF shows the change from the published value, e.g. `−0.450`. It stays empty for unchanged tenors. Untick **Δ** above the grid to hide these

columns.

- **Blue** ATMs are calculated (derived or moving with a parent). **Pink** values come from the FMD feed. Grey cells are read-only.

> **Expiry dates.** Hover over a tenor (ON, 1W, 1M, …) to see its expiry date and the days to expiry, e.g. *Expiry Thu, 3 Dec 2026 (29 days)*. The dates follow the market convention for the pair (section 16).

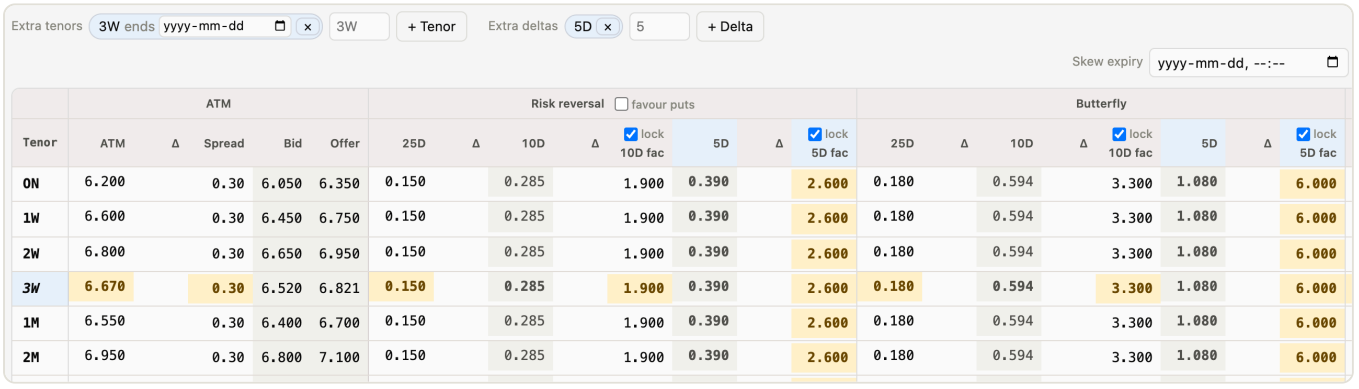
10D: factor or quote

Each 10D has a **lock** box above its factor column, separately for RR and BF.

- **Ticked**: you type the factor; 10D = 25D × factor and the 10D is read-only.
- **Unticked**: you type the 10D quote; the factor is worked out as 10D / 25D. Moving the 25D then keeps the 10D and recalibrates the factor.

Extra tenors and deltas

A pair can carry more than the standard tenors and 25D/10D. Both are set in the **Extra tenors** and **Extra deltas** boxes just above the grid, and both take effect when you publish.



Tenor	ATM	Δ	Spread	Bid	Offer	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	lock 10D fac	5D	Δ	lock 5D fac	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	lock 10D fac	5D	Δ	lock 5D fac
ON	6.200		0.30	6.050	6.350	0.150		0.285		1.900	0.390		2.600	0.180		0.594		3.300	1.080		6.000
1W	6.600		0.30	6.450	6.750	0.150		0.285		1.900	0.390		2.600	0.180		0.594		3.300	1.080		6.000
2W	6.800		0.30	6.650	6.950	0.150		0.285		1.900	0.390		2.600	0.180		0.594		3.300	1.080		6.000
3W	6.670		0.30	6.520	6.821	0.150		0.285		1.900	0.390		2.600	0.180		0.594		3.300	1.080		6.000
1M	6.550		0.30	6.400	6.700	0.150		0.285		1.900	0.390		2.600	0.180		0.594		3.300	1.080		6.000
2M	6.950		0.30	6.800	7.100	0.150		0.285		1.900	0.390		2.600	0.180		0.594		3.300	1.080		6.000

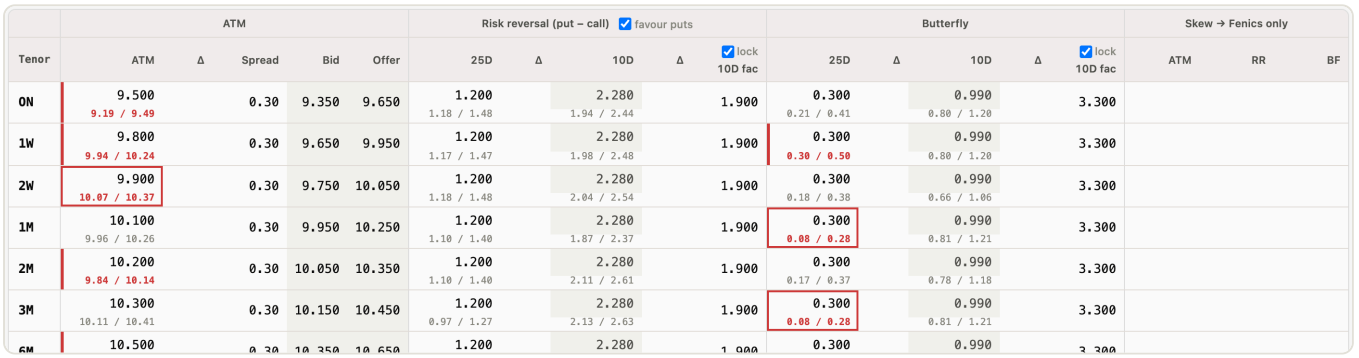
EURUSD with an extra 3W tenor (tinted row, between 2W and 1M) and an extra 5D delta (RR and BF columns with a factor and a lock), not yet published.

- **Extra tenor**: for example **3W** when an event falls between 2W and 1M, or 4M or 5M. Type it and press **+ Tenor** (weeks, months or years: `3W`, `4M`, `18M`). The new row starts at the ATM the curve already gives its expiry with the event weights, so adding it changes nothing until you mark it. RR, BF and spread are interpolated from the neighbouring tenors.
- An extra tenor is marked, checked and exported like any other (Fenics `3w`, Front Arena `3wk`), and the event-weight interpolation uses it as a pillar. Hover over it for its expiry date.
- It stays until you remove it with **×**. To have it go by itself, give it an end date in its box: on that day VolMarker removes it and publishes a new version.

- **Extra delta**: for steep wings, for example **5D** or **1D** (or 30D, inside the 25D). Type the delta and press **+ Delta**. It gets RR and BF columns with a factor and a lock, exactly like the 10D. The starting factors are generic (5D: RR 2.6, BF 6; 1D: RR 4, BF 12), so check them before publishing.
- Extra deltas go to Fenics and Front Arena after the 25D and 10D, and appear in Changes, 3D, the market levels and the alerts (with the 10D's tolerance).
- On a derived pair, an extra tenor is derived only if both base pairs carry it too; otherwise you type its ATM. The same goes for a pair moving with a parent. Pairs marked in Excel keep the standard tenors and 25D/10D.

Favour puts

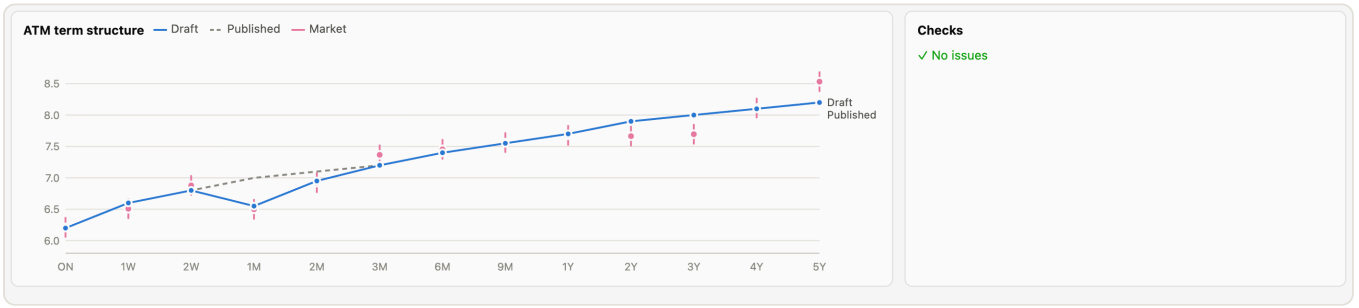
For pairs whose skew favours puts (USDJPY, for example), tick **favour puts** next to the Risk reversal heading. The grid, the market levels, the alerts and the shift toolbar then show RRs as put – call, so you type `1.25` instead of `−1.25`. Only the display flips: the stored marks and the Fenics and Front Arena files stay call – put. It is a pair setting, so publish to share it with the desk.



	ATM					Risk reversal (put – call) ☑ favour puts					Butterfly					Skew → Fenics only		
Tenor	ATM	Δ	Spread	Bid	Offer	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	ATM	RR	BF
ON	9.500 9.19 / 9.49		0.30	9.350	9.650	1.200 1.18 / 1.48		2.280 1.94 / 2.44		1.900	0.300 0.21 / 0.41		0.990 0.80 / 1.20		3.300			
1W	9.800 9.94 / 10.24		0.30	9.650	9.950	1.200 1.17 / 1.47		2.280 1.98 / 2.48		1.900	0.300 0.30 / 0.50		0.990 0.80 / 1.20		3.300			
2W	9.900 10.07 / 10.37		0.30	9.750	10.050	1.200 1.18 / 1.48		2.280 2.04 / 2.54		1.900	0.300 0.18 / 0.38		0.990 0.66 / 1.06		3.300			
1M	10.100 9.96 / 10.26		0.30	9.950	10.250	1.200 1.10 / 1.40		2.280 1.87 / 2.37		1.900	0.300 0.08 / 0.28		0.990 0.81 / 1.21		3.300			
2M	10.200 9.84 / 10.14		0.30	10.050	10.350	1.200 1.10 / 1.40		2.280 2.11 / 2.61		1.900	0.300 0.17 / 0.37		0.990 0.78 / 1.18		3.300			
3M	10.300 10.11 / 10.41		0.30	10.150	10.450	1.200 0.97 / 1.27		2.280 2.13 / 2.63		1.900	0.300 0.08 / 0.28		0.990 0.81 / 1.21		3.300			
6M	10.500		0.30	10.350	10.650	1.200		2.280		1.900	0.300		0.990		3.300			

USDJPY with favour puts: the heading reads *Risk reversal (put – call)* and the RRs are positive.

Below the grid



The **ATM term structure** chart shows your draft (blue) against the published curve (dashed) and the market mids with their bid/offer (pink). Hover for the values. **Checks** lists problems: a missing ATM, a non-positive bid, calendar arbitrage (total variance falling between tenors) or a correlation outside −1 to 1.

5. Market data in the grid

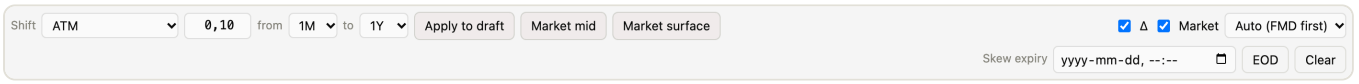
When the FMD feed is running, the broker bid/offer appears in small type under each ATM, RR and BF mark.

- A **red bar** on the left of a cell: your mark is outside the broker range.
- A **red frame**: an active market alert on that mark.
- Faded levels are older than 30 minutes; **Market mid** skips them.
- A `*` means the broker only quoted the other ATM convention (DNS vs ATMF).
- Click a broker level to put its mid in your draft.

The **Market** box above the grid hides or shows the levels. Next to it you choose the source: **Auto (FMD first)** uses the FMD composite, then FMD 1.0 from Fenics, then the individual brokers; **Best of brands** takes the highest bid and lowest offer; or pick a single broker.

> FMD is not raw quotes: it is a calibrated, arbitrage-free surface built from several broker desks and real requests on multi-dealer venues, which is why it is the default reference.

6. Shifts, market levels and skew



Control	What it does
Shift · amount · from · to	Pick a field (ATM, RR, BF, …), an amount and a tenor range, then **Apply to draft** for a parallel shift.
Market mid	Sets the chosen field to the broker mid over the tenor range.
Market surface	Takes ATM, RR and BF (every delta the pair marks) from the market over the range.
Skew expiry · EOD · Clear	When the skew expires. **EOD** sets 17:00 today; **Clear** zeroes all skews.

Taking market levels only changes your draft; nothing is published until you press Publish. On a derived pair or a pair moving with a parent, taking the market ATM recalibrates the correlation or the spread to it.

Skew

The three **Skew → Fenics only** columns shift ATM, RR and BF in the Fenics file only; Front Arena always gets the pure mids. Set an expiry (or press **EOD**). When it passes, VolMarker publishes a clean version by itself.

---

7. Publishing



1. Optionally type a comment, e.g. *1M–2M lower after payrolls*. It shows in the History tab.
2. Press **Publish** or `Ctrl` + `S`.

Publishing saves a new version, writes the Fenics and Front Arena files, and moves every pair that depends on this one (derived crosses, pairs moving with it as a parent) a moment later. **Discard** throws your draft away.

- **Someone else published first?** VolMarker stops and tells you, and never overwrites their version silently. Versions the feed or a base pair made in the meantime are not a conflict: your edits are kept on top of them.
- **Last export** loads the pair's current Front Arena file into your draft, e.g. after someone marked it in Excel. Check it and publish.
- Every manual publish also stores the market mids at that moment, for the audit trail.

---

8. Derived, spread and following pairs

Derived pairs (correlation triangle)

		ATM					Risk reversal ☐ favour puts				Butterfly				Skew → Fenics only		
Tenor	Corr	ATM	Δ	Spread	Bid	Offer	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	ATM	RR	BF
ON	0.758	4.600 4.45 / 4.75		0.60	4.300	4.900	−0.600 −0.80 / −0.50		−1.140 −1.28 / −0.78		1.900	0.200 −0.01 / 0.19		0.660 0.36 / 0.76		3.300			
1W	0.751	4.900 4.83 / 5.13		0.60	4.600	5.200	−0.600 −0.75 / −0.45		−1.140 −1.35 / −0.85		1.900	0.200 0.12 / 0.32		0.660 0.29 / 0.69		3.300			
2W	0.755	5.000 4.88 / 5.18		0.60	4.700	5.300	−0.600 −0.74 / −0.44		−1.140 −1.41 / −0.91		1.900	0.200 0.24 / 0.44		0.660 0.49 / 0.89		3.300			
1M	0.759	5.010 5.07 / 5.37		0.60	4.710	5.310	−0.600 −0.72 / −0.42		−1.140 −1.58 / −1.08		1.900	0.200 −0.02 / 0.18		0.660 0.44 / 0.84		3.300			
2M	0.756	5.165 5.08 / 5.38		0.60	4.865	5.465	−0.600 −0.84 / −0.54		−1.140 −1.49 / −0.99		1.900	0.200 0.16 / 0.36		0.660 0.31 / 0.71		3.300			
3M	0.753	5.326 4.91 / 5.21		0.60	5.026	5.626	−0.600 −0.74 / −0.44		−1.140 −1.49 / −0.99		1.900	0.200 0.24 / 0.44		0.660 0.41 / 0.81		3.300			
6M	0.745	5.500		0.60	5.200	5.800	−0.600		−1.140		1.900	0.200		0.660		3.300			

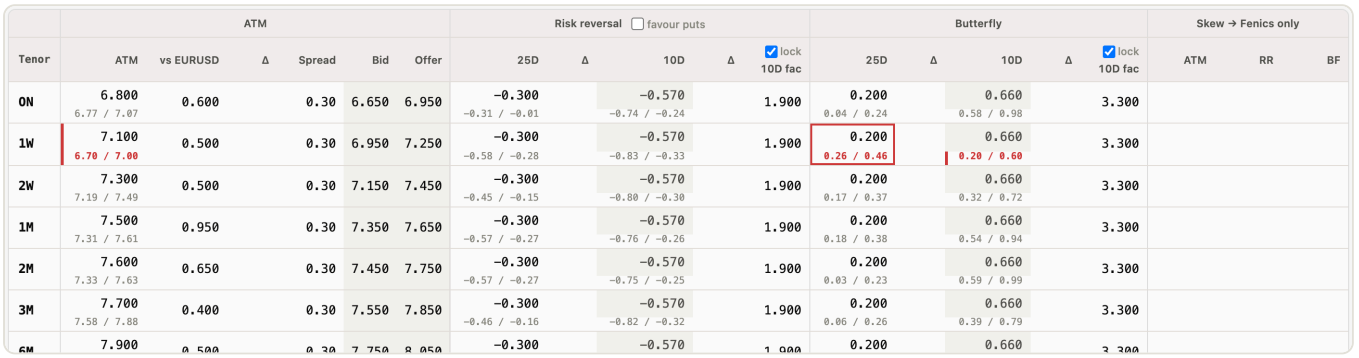
EURCHF derived from EURUSD and USDCHF: a **Corr** column and blue ATMs.

A derived pair's ATM comes from its two base pairs and a correlation per tenor: $\sigma^2 = \sigma_1^2 + \sigma_2^2 + 2 \cdot s_1 \cdot s_2 \cdot \rho \cdot \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2$. The correlation is between the two bases *as quoted*, so EURUSD against USDCHF is

strongly negative.

- When a base is published, the derived pair follows by itself.
- Type an ATM to calibrate that tenor's correlation to it; the pair then keeps running off its bases.
- Untick **Move with bases** (Setup) to hold the ATMs where they are while the bases move. The correlation (grey) then shows what they imply.
- RR and BF are marked by hand, as in Excel.

Spread to a parent

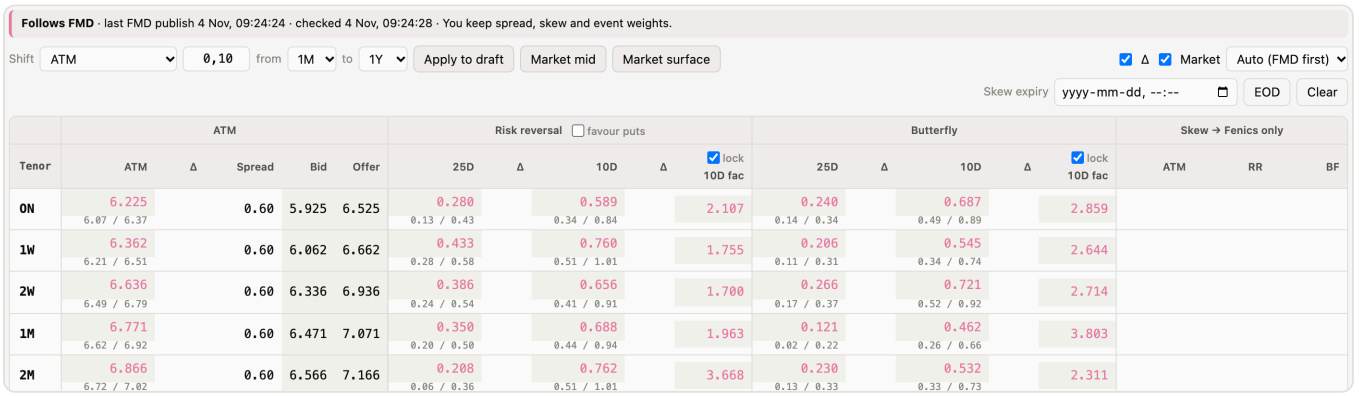


	ATM					Risk reversal ☐ favour puts					Butterfly					Skew → Fenics only		
Tenor	ATM	vs EURUSD	Δ	Spread	Bid	Offer	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	ATM	RR	BF
ON	6.800 6.77 / 7.07	0.600		0.30	6.650	6.950	−0.300 −0.31 / −0.01		−0.570 −0.74 / −0.24		1.900	0.200 0.04 / 0.24		0.660 0.58 / 0.98		3.300			
1W	7.100 6.70 / 7.00	0.500		0.30	6.950	7.250	−0.300 −0.58 / −0.28		−0.570 −0.83 / −0.33		1.900	0.200 0.26 / 0.46		0.660 0.20 / 0.60		3.300			
2W	7.300 7.19 / 7.49	0.500		0.30	7.150	7.450	−0.300 −0.45 / −0.15		−0.570 −0.80 / −0.30		1.900	0.200 0.17 / 0.37		0.660 0.32 / 0.72		3.300			
1M	7.500 7.31 / 7.61	0.950		0.30	7.350	7.650	−0.300 −0.57 / −0.27		−0.570 −0.76 / −0.26		1.900	0.200 0.18 / 0.38		0.660 0.54 / 0.94		3.300			
2M	7.600 7.33 / 7.63	0.650		0.30	7.450	7.750	−0.300 −0.57 / −0.27		−0.570 −0.75 / −0.25		1.900	0.200 0.03 / 0.23		0.660 0.59 / 0.99		3.300			
3M	7.700 7.58 / 7.88	0.400		0.30	7.550	7.850	−0.300 −0.46 / −0.16		−0.570 −0.82 / −0.32		1.900	0.200 0.06 / 0.26		0.660 0.39 / 0.79		3.300			
6M	7.900	0.500		0.30	7.750	8.050	−0.300		−0.570		1.900	0.200		0.660		3.300			

GBPUSD with EURUSD as spread parent: the **vs EURUSD** column.

Set a **Spread parent** in Setup to get a column with this pair's ATM minus the parent's published ATM. Type either one: an ATM updates the spread, a spread sets ATM = parent + spread. Tick **Move with parent** to keep the spreads instead: every publish of the parent then moves this pair's ATMs, which show in blue.

Follow FMD (market mode)



Follows FMD · last FMD publish 4 Nov, 09:24:24 · checked 4 Nov, 09:24:28 · You keep spread, skew and event weights.

Shift ATM 0,10 from 1M to 1Y Apply to draft Market mid Market surface ☑ Δ ☑ Market Auto (FMD first)

Skew expiry yyyy-mm-dd, --:-- EOD Clear

	ATM					Risk reversal ☐ favour puts					Butterfly					Skew → Fenics only		
Tenor	ATM	Δ	Spread	Bid	Offer	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	25D	Δ	10D	Δ	☑ lock 10D fac	ATM	RR	BF
ON	6.225 6.07 / 6.37		0.60	5.925	6.525	0.280 0.13 / 0.43		0.589 0.34 / 0.84		2.107	0.240 0.14 / 0.34		0.687 0.49 / 0.89		2.859			
1W	6.362 6.21 / 6.51		0.60	6.062	6.662	0.433 0.28 / 0.58		0.760 0.51 / 1.01		1.755	0.206 0.11 / 0.31		0.545 0.34 / 0.74		2.644			
2W	6.636 6.49 / 6.79		0.60	6.336	6.936	0.386 0.24 / 0.54		0.656 0.41 / 0.91		1.700	0.266 0.17 / 0.37		0.721 0.52 / 0.92		2.714			
1M	6.771 6.62 / 6.92		0.60	6.471	7.071	0.350 0.20 / 0.50		0.688 0.44 / 0.94		1.963	0.121 0.02 / 0.22		0.462 0.26 / 0.66		3.803			
2M	6.866 6.72 / 7.02		0.60	6.566	7.166	0.208 0.06 / 0.36		0.762 0.51 / 1.01		3.668	0.230 0.13 / 0.33		0.532 0.33 / 0.73		2.311			

EURSEK follows FMD: the market fields are pink and read-only; the bar on top shows the last FMD publish.

Tick **Follow FMD** in Setup and the feed publishes the FMD mids for ATM, 25D/10D RR and BF by itself, through the normal publish. You keep the spread, skew and event weights.

- It publishes when any mark has moved at least 0.05 vol, at most every 15 seconds.

- **Jump guard**: a very large move is held for a minute and taken only if it is still there. Meanwhile the pair is amber and an alert explains.
- **Feed down**: nothing is published, Fenics keeps the last levels, the pair turns red and everyone gets an alert.
- Untick Follow FMD and save to take the pair back; the current levels become your marks.

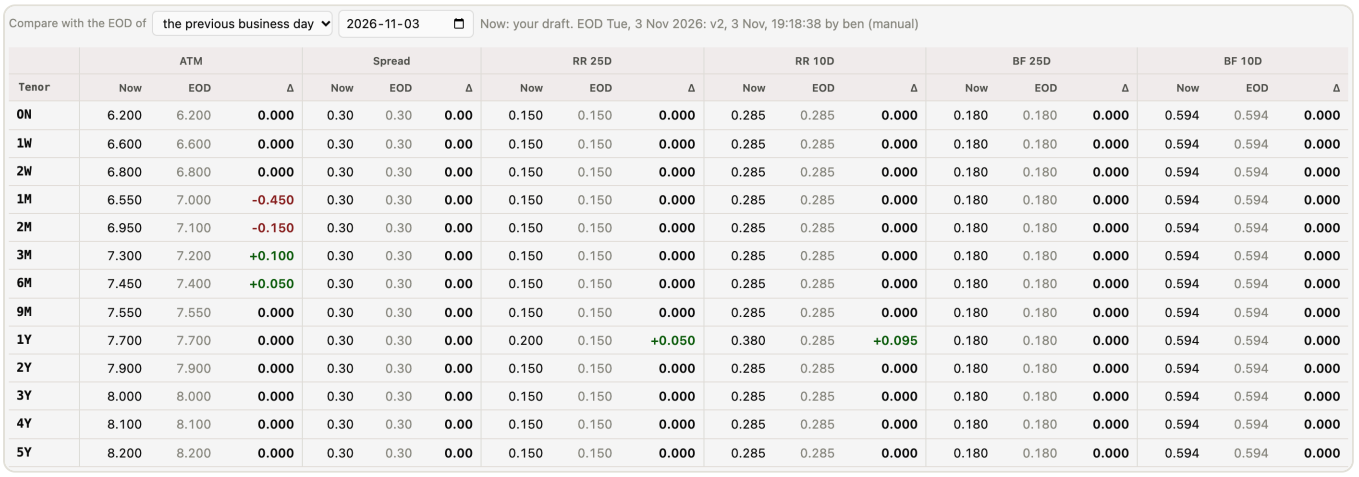
Marked in Excel

For pairs still marked in the Excel workbook, tick **Marked in Excel** in Setup. VolMarker then reads the pair's Front Arena file whenever Excel writes a newer one and publishes it as a new version. Its marks are read-only in VolMarker and VolMarker never writes its files. If a pair *not* marked in Excel has its file changed by someone else, everyone gets an alert, because the two would overwrite each other.

---

9. Changes, 3D and History

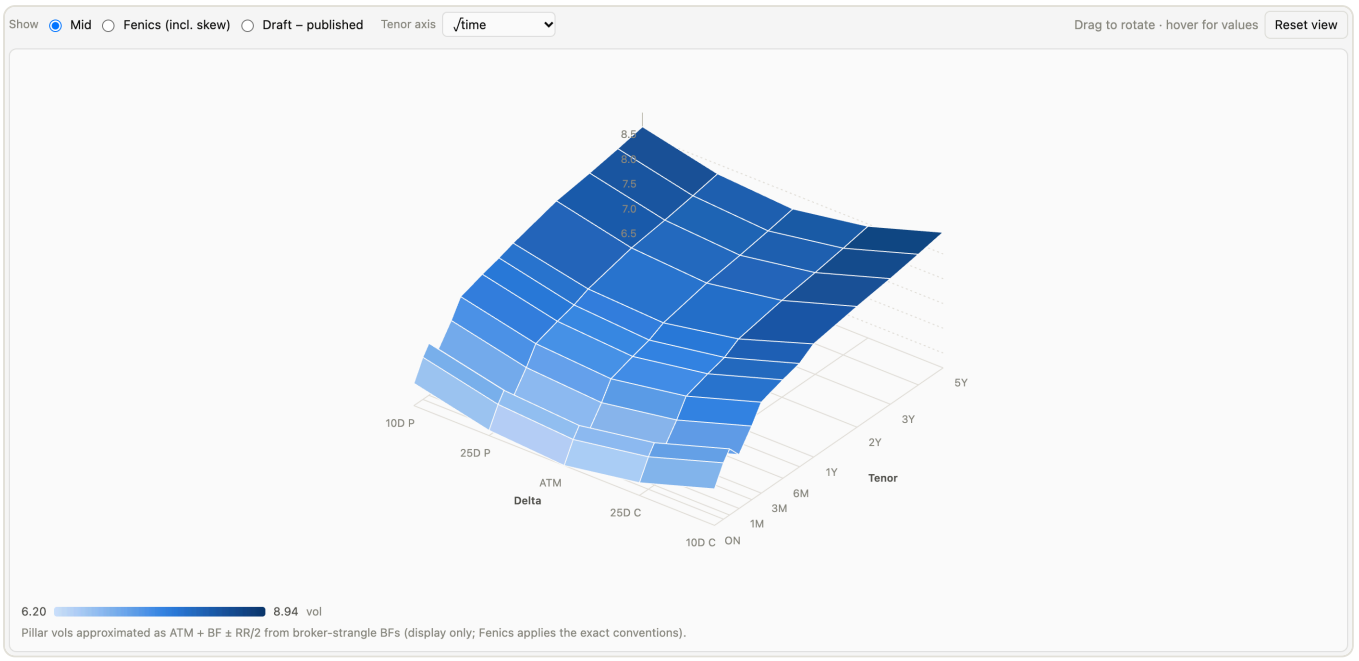
Changes



	ATM			Spread			RR 25D			RR 10D			BF 25D			BF 10D		
Tenor	Now	EOD	Δ	Now	EOD	Δ	Now	EOD	Δ	Now	EOD	Δ	Now	EOD	Δ	Now	EOD	Δ
ON	6.200	6.200	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
1W	6.600	6.600	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
2W	6.800	6.800	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
1M	6.550	7.000	-0.450	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
2M	6.950	7.100	-0.150	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
3M	7.300	7.200	+0.100	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
6M	7.450	7.400	+0.050	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
9M	7.550	7.550	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
1Y	7.700	7.700	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.200	0.150	+0.050	0.380	0.285	+0.095	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
2Y	7.900	7.900	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
3Y	8.000	8.000	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
4Y	8.100	8.100	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000
5Y	8.200	8.200	0.000	0.30	0.30	0.00	0.150	0.150	0.000	0.285	0.285	0.000	0.180	0.180	0.000	0.594	0.594	0.000

Today's marks next to an earlier day's end of day, per tenor: *Now*, *EOD* and *Δ* (green up, red down). The EOD of a day is the last version published before midnight. By default you compare with the previous business day (on a Monday, Friday's); pick *one week ago* or any date instead. *Now* is your draft, so the Δ follows your edits before you publish.

3D



The surface over delta (10D put to 10D call, or the pair's widest extra delta) and tenor. Drag to rotate, hover for values. Show the mid, the Fenics surface with skew, or *Draft – published* to see your unpublished changes. The wings are an approximation (ATM + BF ± RR/2), for display only.

History



v	Time	User	Source	Comment	1M ATM	1Y ATM	
3	4 Nov, 09:20:41	anna	manual	1M–2M lower after payrolls	6.550	7.700	
2	3 Nov, 19:18:38	ben	manual	demo marks	7.000	7.700	Restore
1	3 Nov, 19:18:38	ben	manual	created			Restore

Every version with its time, user, source (manual, market, propagation, Excel…) and comment. **Restore** copies an old version into your draft; check it and publish. Nothing is ever deleted: old months are archived and still show here (section 17).

---

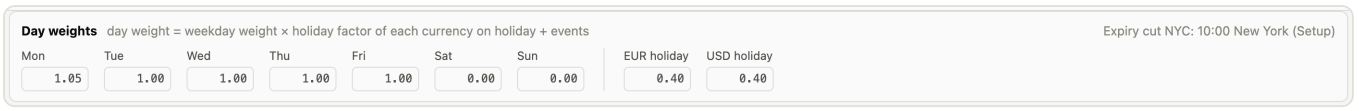
10. Event weights

Event weights decide how the ATM is interpolated between the marked tenors, so that event days carry more variance than quiet days and weekends carry little. The method is the one in the desk's Excel weight workbook and in Fenics:

day weight = weekday weight × holiday factor(ccy1) × holiday factor(ccy2) + events

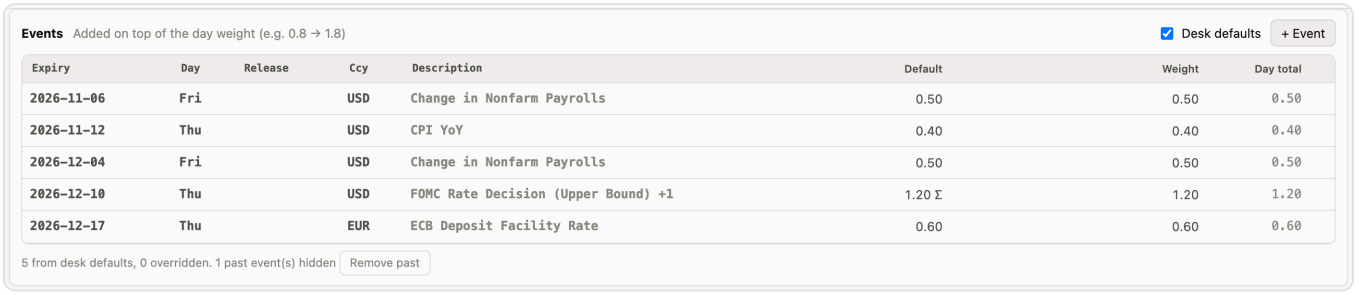
Total variance is interpolated linearly in weighted time between the marked tenors.

Day weights



Seven weekday weights (e.g. Monday 1.05, Tuesday to Friday 1, weekend 0) and a holiday factor per currency (e.g. 0.4) that applies on that currency's holidays. A holiday in both currencies gives 0.4 × 0.4.

Events

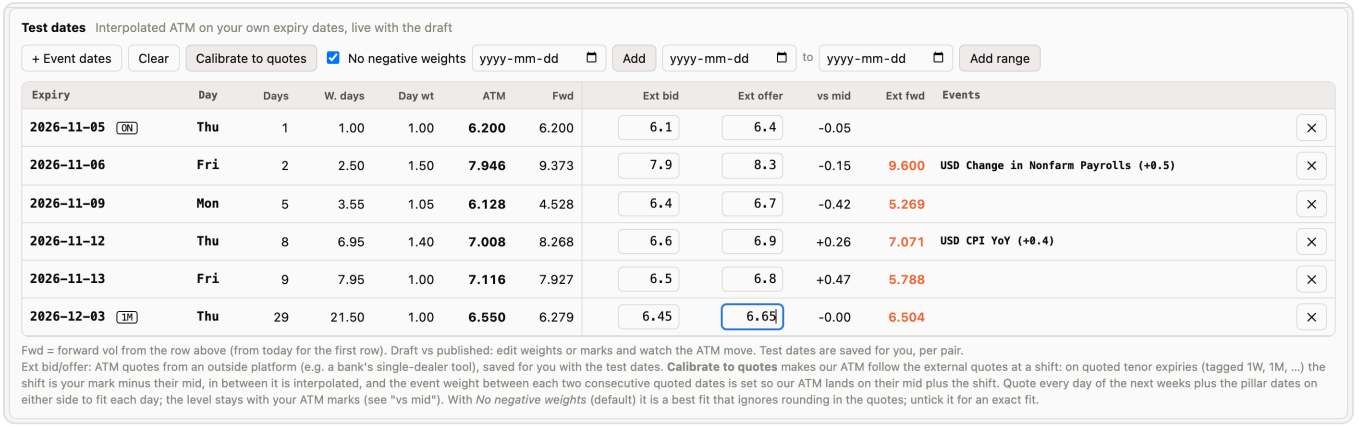


The pair's events, each on the option expiry it weighs on, with its release time, currency, the desk default and the weight used. Events from the desk's list (section 11) come in by themselves.

- Type a weight to override the default for this pair; ↺ goes back to the default; `0` switches the event off.
- **+ Event** adds a one-off (an election, say). The new row appears at the top and moves to its place once it has a description.
- Several events of one currency on one expiry add up; hover over the **Σ** for the breakdown.
- Untick **Desk defaults** to ignore the desk's list for this pair.

> **Which expiry does an event weigh on?** The first good business day whose expiry cut comes after the release. With the New York 10:00 cut, FOMC at 14:00 New York on Wednesday weighs on Thursday, while the ECB at 14:15 Frankfurt (08:15 New York) weighs on the same day.

Test dates and external quotes



Type your own expiry dates to see the interpolated ATM, calendar and weighted days and the forward vol, live as you edit weights or marks. **+ Event dates** adds each upcoming event's expiry and the weekday before and after it; **Add range** adds every weekday between two dates. Pillar expiries are tagged (`ON`, `1M`, ...).

Ext bid / Ext offer take ATM quotes from an outside platform, for example a bank's single-dealer tool for events months ahead. Type bid, `Tab`, offer, `Enter` to jump to the next date's bid. *vs mid* shows our level against theirs and *Ext fwd* their forward vol.

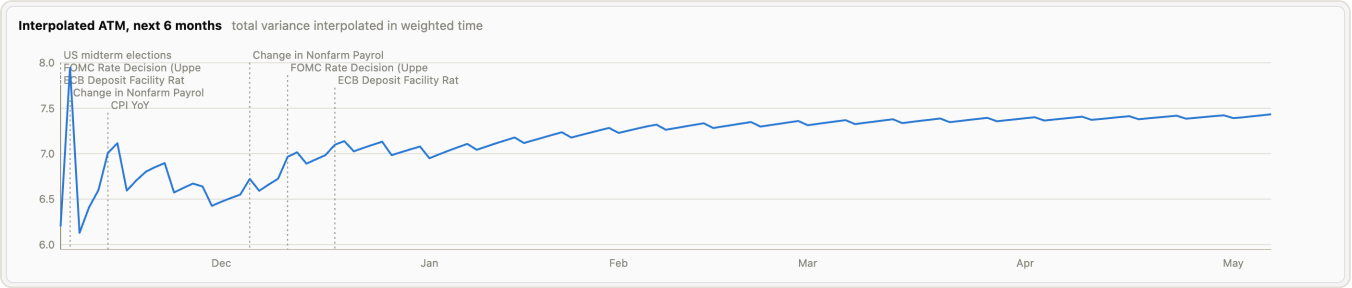
Calibrate to quotes makes our ATM follow the external quotes at a shift: on quoted pillars the shift is your mark minus their mid, and in between the event weights are set so that our ATM lands on their mid plus the shift. With **No negative weights** ticked (the default) it is a best fit that ignores rounding in the quotes; untick it for an exact fit. Review the weights, then publish.

Market dailies



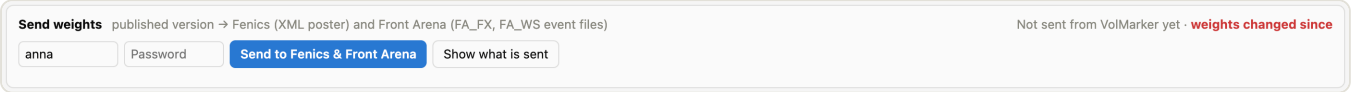
The FMD dailies (1D–14D) against your weights: market forward vol (pink) and yours (blue) per daily expiry. *Implied event* is the event weight the market prices on that day. **Calibrate event weights to dailies** writes those implied weights into your draft, keeping the weekend and holiday factors.

The next six months



The interpolated ATM for every expiry over the next six months, draft against published, so you can see the bumps your events make.

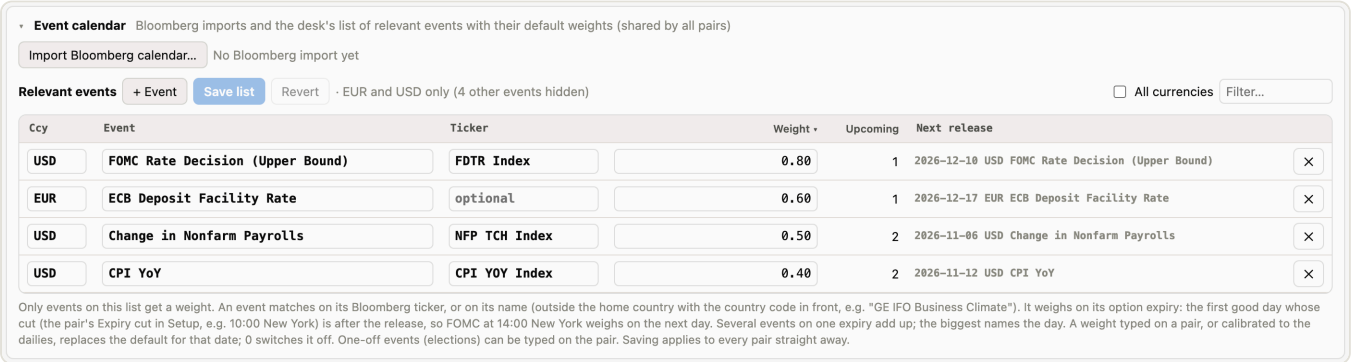
Sending the weights



Send to Fenics & Front Arena sends the *published* version's weights to Fenics (XML poster) and writes the Front Arena event files (FA_FX and FA_WS). Leave the password empty if you are logged in to Fenics. The card says when weights, defaults or the calendar have changed since the last send. **Show what is sent** lists every line.

---

11. The event calendar



At the bottom of the Event weights tab. It is shared by all pairs.

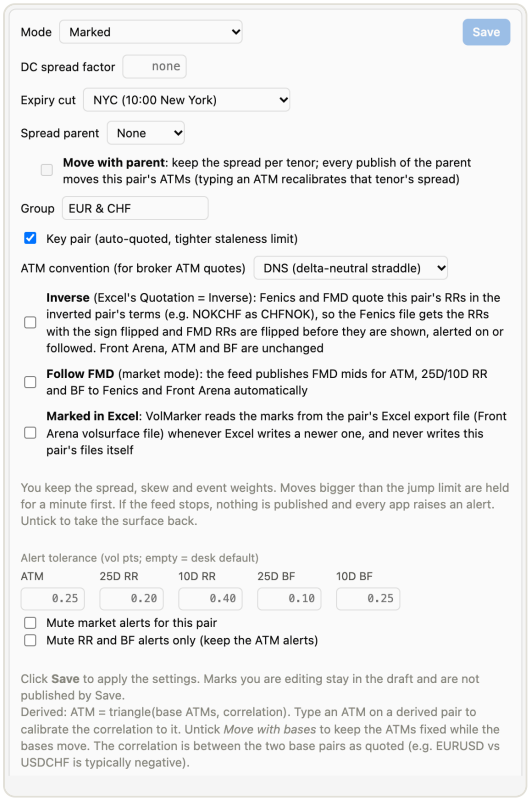
- **Import Bloomberg calendar...** takes an ECO export saved as .xlsx (one file per currency or region). Tick the relevant events, set their default weight and import. A new import replaces the

previous one for that currency.

- **Relevant events** is the desk's list. Only events on it get a weight. An event matches on its Bloomberg ticker or its name. The list shows the selected pair's currencies; tick **All currencies** to see everything. Sorted by weight.
- **+ Event** adds an event to the list. The filter stays as it is, and the new row stays at the top until it has a name. **Save list** applies it to every pair straight away.

---

12. Pair settings (Setup)

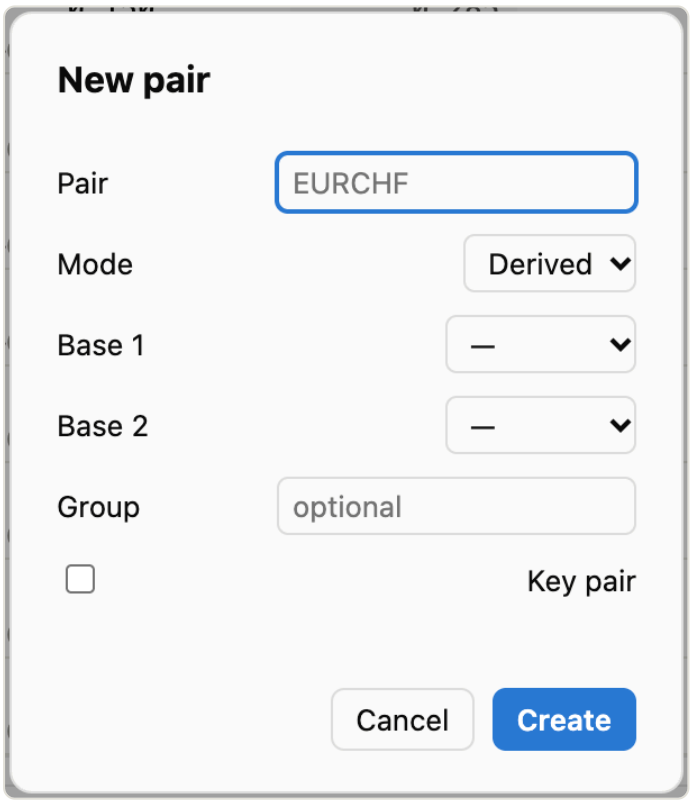


Settings are shared by the whole desk. Change them and press the tab's own **Save**: this publishes a version with the new settings on the latest marks. Marks you are editing stay in your draft, and the pair's staleness clock is not reset. If someone changed the settings meanwhile, Save stops and says so.

Setting	Meaning
Mode	*Marked* or *Derived* (then choose the two bases and **Move with bases**).
DC spread factor	Pairs with a factor of at least 0.01 get a DC spread file (ATM spread × 0.5 × factor).
Expiry cut	NYC 10:00 New York, TOK 15:00 Tokyo, and others. Decides which expiry an event weighs on.

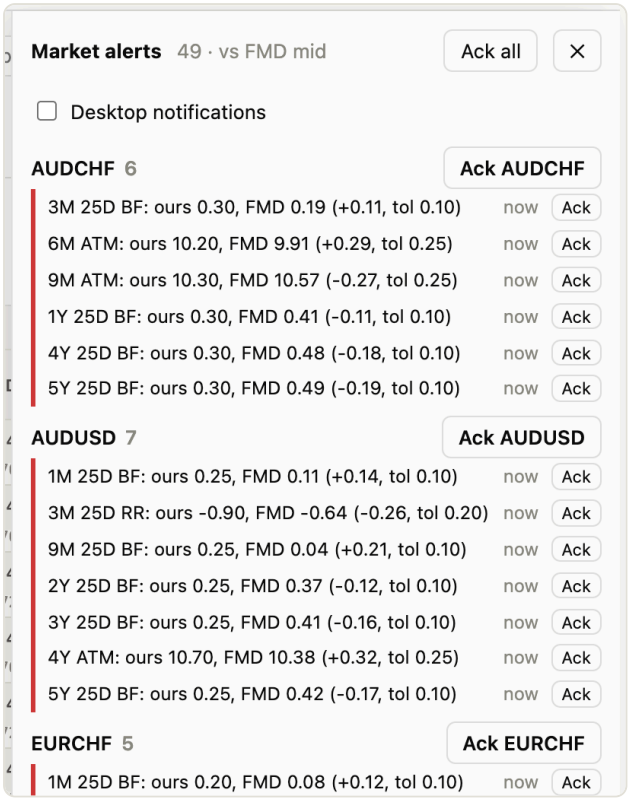
Setting	Meaning
Spread parent	Adds the spread column; **Move with parent** keeps the spreads (section 8).
Group	Where the pair is listed in the sidebar, for everyone.
Key pair	Auto-quoted, with the tighter staleness limit.
ATM convention	DNS or ATMF, used to match broker ATM quotes.
Inverse	Fenics and FMD quote the pair's RRs in the inverted pair's terms (e.g. NOKCHF as CHFNOK), so their sign is flipped going to Fenics and coming from FMD.
Follow FMD	Market mode (section 8).
Marked in Excel	Read the marks from Excel's export file (section 8).
Alert tolerance	Per-pair tolerances in vol points; empty uses the desk default. Mute all alerts, or only the RR and BF ones.

New pairs



+ New pair in the top bar. Type the pair, choose Marked or Derived (with its two bases), an optional group and whether it is a key pair. If a Front Arena file for the pair already exists, the new pair starts from its marks, so the first publish doesn't blank the file.

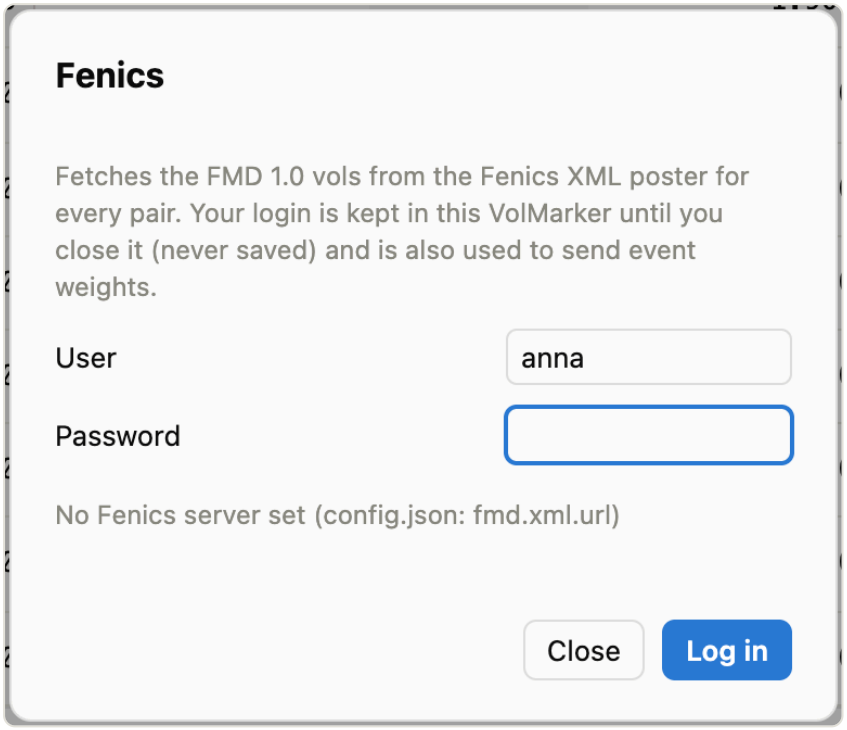
13. Market alerts



VolMarker compares every pair's *published* mids (without skew) with FMD and raises an alert when they drift apart by more than the tolerance (by default ATM 0.25, 25D RR 0.20, 10D RR 0.40, 25D BF 0.10, 10D BF 0.25, wider at the short end).

- A gap must last 20 seconds before it alerts, and clears once it is below 80 % of the tolerance, so alerts don't flicker.
- Alerts show in the ⚠ button, the browser tab's title, the sidebar and as red frames in the grid. Tick **Desktop notifications** to get a pop-up; clicking it opens the pair.
- **Ack** mutes an alert for you until it clears or the gap grows by another full tolerance. **Ack AUDCHF** and **Ack all** do several at once.
- Derived crosses are checked against the FMD cross quote too, so a stale correlation shows up.
- Pairs following FMD get "not updating" and "move held" alerts instead.
- An alert also warns when a pair's export file was changed outside VolMarker (e.g. by Excel).

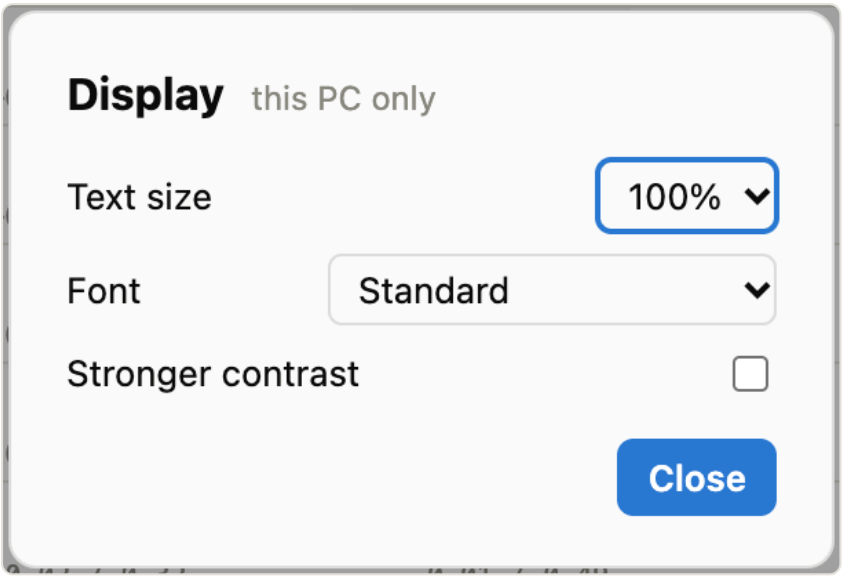
14. Fenics login and the FMD feed



One feed serves the whole desk and writes the market levels to the shared folder; every VolMarker reads them from there. With FMD 1.0, the usual way is **Fenics login** in the top bar: type your Fenics user and password. That VolMarker then fetches every pair's surface from Fenics until you log out or close it.

- **every ... s / min** next to the button sets how often (default 5 minutes, at least 10 seconds). Shorten it around an event; it applies at once.
- The password is kept in memory only, never saved. It is also used by **Send weights** when you leave its password empty.
- Only one feed runs per data folder, so a login is refused while someone else's feed is alive.
- FMD 1.0 gives a bid/offer for the ATM only; RRs and strangles come as mids and show as `mid` in the grid.

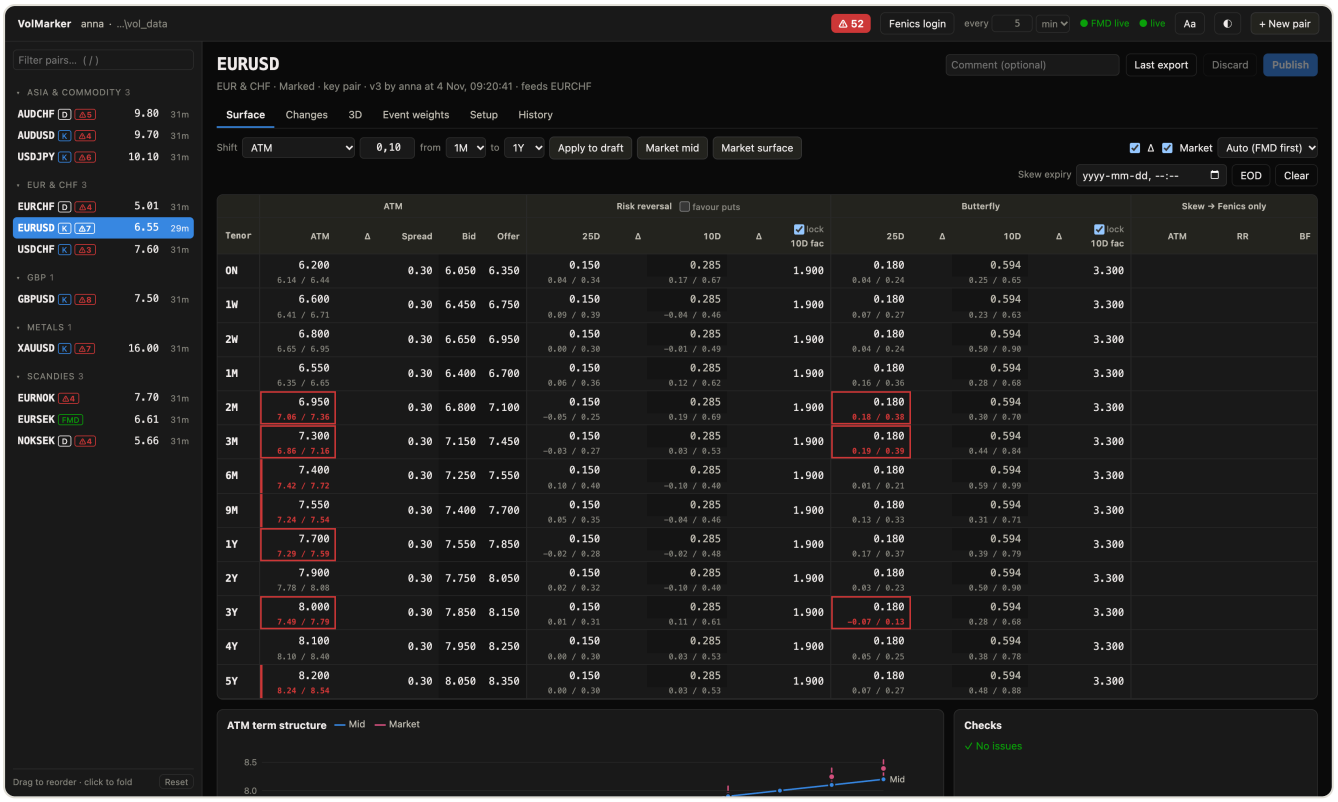
15. Display settings



Aa in the top bar. These settings apply to your PC only; nobody else's screen changes.

- **Text size**: 100 %, 110 %, 125 % or 140 %. The whole page grows. At 140 % the grid is wider than most screens and scrolls sideways.
- **Font**: Standard; Atkinson Hyperlegible (designed for low vision; falls back to Verdana if its font files are missing); Verdana or Tahoma with Consolas, both standard on Windows.
- **Stronger contrast**: darker grey text and grid lines, in light and dark mode.

> For easier reading, try **Verdana / Consolas at 125 %** with **Stronger contrast** ticked.



Dark mode (◐ in the top bar).

---

16. How expiry dates are worked out

Tenor expiries follow the FX market convention, the same as the Excel workbook's `fx_option_expiry`:

Tenor	Rule
ON / 1D	The next weekday. Friday's ON expires on Monday. Holidays don't move it.
1W, 2W	Exactly 7 or 14 calendar days. Holidays don't move them.
Months and years	Delivery = spot + the period, as for an FX forward (modified following, end-of-month rule). The expiry is the delivery stepped back by the spot days; it may fall on a holiday.

- **Spot** is 2 business days (1 for USDCAD, USDTRY and USDRUB). Holidays of the pair's currencies push it back, except USD and ILS holidays, which only matter if they fall on the value date itself. The value date must be good for both currencies and for USD, crosses included.
- **Metals** settle on the calendar of their loco: gold and silver (loco London) on GBP holidays, platinum and palladium (loco Zurich) on CHF holidays.
- VolMarker only knows the holidays in `calendar/holidays.csv`. A missing holiday moves expiries too, so keep that file up to date for every currency you trade.

17. Files, history and the leader app

What each publish writes

File	Content
`<PAIR>volsurface.txt` (Front Arena)	Pure mids, never skewed. CNH pairs are written as CNY, which is what Front Arena expects.
`<PAIR>volsurface.txt` (Fenics)	The quoted surface, skew included.
`<PAIR>spreads.txt`	The DC spread file, for pairs with a DC spread factor.
`<PAIR>_date_time.csv`	A copy of the Fenics file for every manual publish, as the Excel macro made.

Files are written under a temporary name and then renamed, so Fenics and Front Arena never read a half-written file.

History and archive

Every version of every pair is kept. Once a day, whole months older than 90 days move into compressed monthly archive files next to the pair's history. Nothing is deleted: the History and Changes tabs read the archive when they need to.

Market history

Every 5 minutes, the leader app also records the FMD quotes of every pair, so the desk can later study how the market moved around events. Only quotes that changed are stored, so quiet periods cost almost nothing. Recording runs in the background and doesn't slow VolMarker down.

Analysing the history

The `analysis` folder in the data folder holds the desk's vol history as tables you can open in Excel or load into Python or R, one file per month:

Folder	Content
`marks/`	Every published surface, with its time, pair, tenor, expiry date, ATM mid/bid/offer, spread, RR and BF, and who published it. Extra tenors are rows like the others; extra deltas are in the last column, `wings` (e.g. `rr5=-1.2;bf5=0.9`). Includes the dated copies from the Excel years.

`marks_eod/`	Each pair's end-of-day surface.
`atm_eod_wide/`	The end-of-day ATMs of all pairs side by side, one column per pair and tenor.
`market/`	The recorded FMD quotes, one file per day.

Every morning VolMarker adds the previous day by itself. The files are compressed (`.csv.gz`): 7-Zip unpacks them for Excel, and Python and R read them directly.

The leader

One running VolMarker at a time does the desk's shared housekeeping: the daily archive, recording the market, adding the previous day to the analysis tables, expiring skews, removing extra tenors on their end date, reading Excel's files for pairs marked in Excel, and the alert log. It is normally the first one started in the morning. If it closes, another running app takes over within about 45 seconds. Nobody has to do anything about it.

---

18. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
"... was changed to vN by ..." on Publish	Someone else published first. Your draft is kept: look at their change (History), adjust and publish again.
No market levels in the grid	The top bar shows *FMD off*: nobody's feed is running. Log in to Fenics, or ask whoever runs the feed.
`XL?` or an alert that a file was changed outside VolMarker	Excel still exports that pair. Either tick **Marked in Excel** in Setup, or stop exporting it from Excel.
config.json problem in the header	The settings file couldn't be read, often a Windows path with single backslashes. Hover for details, and see section 20.
A pair turns `stale`	Not published within its limit (2 hours for key pairs, 24 for others). Check the marks and publish.

Symptom	What to do
Expiry dates look wrong	Check that `calendar/holidays.csv` has the holidays of both currencies (and GBP or CHF for metals).

19. Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
`Ctrl` + `S`	Publish
`/`	Filter pairs
`Enter` · `↓` · `↑`	Next or previous tenor in the grid
`Tab`	Next column
`Esc`	Undo the cell's edit; a second `Esc` restores the published value
`Tab` / `Enter` in Ext bid/offer	Bid → offer → next date's bid

20. Settings for administrators (config.json)

All shared settings live in `config.json` in the data folder. VolMarker writes it with every default on first start; change only what you need, since a setting left out takes its default. Changes apply without a restart. Folder paths can be absolute or relative to the data folder. In Windows paths, write double backslashes (`"…\\vol_data\\exports"`) or forward slashes (`"…/vol_data/exports"`). If the file can't be read, every setting falls back to its default and the header shows *config.json problem*; hover over it for the reason.

Passwords and secrets are never stored in `config.json` : they come from environment variables or a local file on the PC that runs the feed.

Export folders and files

Setting	Default	Meaning
`fenics_dir`	`exports/fenics`	Where the Fenics vol files go (quoted surface, skew included).
`frontarena_dir`	`exports/frontarena`	Where the Front Arena vol files go (pure mids).

`dc_spread_dir`	`exports/dc_spread`	DC spread files, for pairs with a DC spread factor.
`history_dir`	`exports/history`	A dated copy of the Fenics file for every manual publish. Empty (`""`): no copies.
`excel_dir`	empty	Where Excel writes the files of pairs marked in Excel. Empty: `frontarena_dir`.
`frontarena_ccy`	`{"CNH": "CNY"}`	Currencies Front Arena knows under another code. Used in Front Arena file names and lines only; Fenics keeps the original code.

Staleness, history and market data

Setting	Default	Meaning
`stale_minutes_key`	120	A key pair not published for this long is flagged stale.
`stale_minutes_other`	1440	The same for all other pairs.
`archive_keep_days`	90	Versions older than this (whole months) move to the monthly archive. 0 switches archiving off.
`market_stale_minutes`	30	Broker quotes older than this are shown faded, skipped by Market mid and not followed.
`fmd_brand`	`auto`	Default market source: `auto` (FMD first), `best` (best of brands) or one brand.
`fmd_daily_basis`	`calendar`	Dailies: "ND" = today + N calendar days, rolled to a good day.
`calendar_tz`	`Europe/Zurich`	Time zone of the Bloomberg terminal the calendar is exported from.
`market_record.interval_min`	5	How often the leader app records the FMD quotes for analysis. 0 switches recording off.

`market_record.brands`	`["FMD", "FMD1"]`	Which brands to record. Empty: all.
`market_record.dir`	`market_history`	Where the recordings go, one compressed file per month.
`analysis_dir`	`analysis`	Where the tables for analysis go. Each morning the leader adds the previous day. Empty (`""`): off. To fill in the past once, including the dated copies from the Excel years, run `python scripts/export_history.py --data …\vol_data` ; see the README.

Market data feed (`fmd`)

Setting	Meaning
`transport`	`fix` (FMD over FIX), `webapi` (FMD over HTTPS) or `xml` (FMD 1.0 polled from the Fenics XML poster, as with the Fenics login button).
`host` , `port` , `tls`	The FIX server (the vendor's UAT by default).
`sender_comp_id` , `target_comp_id` , `session_qualifier` , `heartbeat`	FIX session details from the vendor.
`product` , `filters`	What to subscribe to; `filters` narrows it, e.g. `[[16999, "EUR"]]` .
`password_env` , `password_file`	Where the FIX password comes from (environment variable `FMD_PASSWORD` by default).
`webapi.*`	For `webapi` : `base_url` , `token_url` , `client_id` , the secret's variable or file, `ca_file` for a proxy that inspects TLS, plus stream tuning (`conflation` , `snapshot_age` , `idle_timeout`).
`xml.url`	For `xml` : the Fenics pricing server. Empty uses `weights_export.fenics_url` .
`xml.username` , `xml.password_env` , `xml.password_file`	Login for the command-line feed (the Fenics login button asks instead).

`xml.interval`	Seconds between rounds over all pairs (300) for the command-line feed; the button has its own field.
`xml.pairs`	Pairs to fetch; empty = every pair in VolMarker.
`xml.atm_type`, `xml.scale`, `xml.brand`	Fenics' ATM convention (DNS), the factor from its decimals to vol points (100), and the brand name its quotes show under (FMD1).
`xml.retry_missing`, `xml.timeout`, `xml.raw_dir`	How long before asking again for a pair Fenics has no vols for (3600 s), the request timeout, and an optional folder for the raw answers, for debugging.

Event weights (`weights_export`, `cuts`)

Setting	Meaning
`weights_export.fenics_url`	The Fenics pricing server that **Send weights** posts to (`/xmlposter` is added).
`weights_export.fenics_dir`, `fa_fx_dir`, `fa_ws_dir`	Where the copy of the Fenics message and the Front Arena FA_FX and FA_WS event files go.
`weights_export.date_format`	Date format in the Front Arena event files (`%Y-%m-%d`).
`cuts`	The expiry cuts offered in Setup, each a time zone and time, e.g. `"WAR": {"tz": "Europe/Warsaw", "time": "11:00"}`. `times` sets another time on some weekdays, e.g. `{"Fri": "12:00"}`.

Derived pairs, Follow FMD and alerts

Setting	Default	Meaning
`propagation.min_change`	0.005	After a market-driven move, a derived or parent-following pair is republished only if an ATM moves at least this much…
`propagation.min_corr_change`	0.005	…or, on a cross whose ATMs stay put, the implied correlation moves at least this much…
`propagation.min_interval_s`	5	…and at most this often. Manual publishes always go through.
`follow.min_change`	0.05	Follow FMD publishes when any mark has moved at least this much (vol points).

`follow.min_publish_interval_s`	15	At most one automatic publish per pair this often.
`follow.max_jump`	ATM 1.0, 25D RR 0.75, 10D RR 1.5, 25D BF 0.5, 10D BF 1.0	Bigger moves are held…
`follow.jump_confirm_s`	60	…until they have lasted this long.
`follow.interval_s`	2	How often the follower looks at the market.
`alerts.enabled`	true	Market alerts on or off for the desk.
`alerts.basis`	`mid`	`mid`: distance to the market mid; `range`: distance outside the bid/offer.
`alerts.tolerance`	ATM 0.25, 25D RR 0.20, 10D RR 0.40, 25D BF 0.10, 10D BF 0.25	Default tolerances; each pair can override them in Setup.
`alerts.tenor_scale`	ON ×2, 1W ×1.5, 2W ×1.25	Wider tolerances at the short end.
`alerts.confirm_s`	20	A gap must last this long before it alerts.
`alerts.clear_ratio`	0.8	An alert clears once the gap is below this share of the tolerance.

Other files in the data folder

File	Content
`calendar/holidays.csv`	Holidays, one per line: `ccy,date`. Drives expiry dates and holiday weights.
`calendar/events.csv`	Manual dated events (e.g. elections): `ccy,date,description`.
`calendar/event_defaults.csv`	The desk's relevant events and default weights (edited in the app).
`calendar/bloomberg/`	The last Bloomberg calendar import per currency.
`pairs/<PAIR>/`	Every version of the pair, plus its monthly archive.

`market_history/`	The recorded FMD quotes, one compressed file per month: only quotes that changed since the last round, and a full set at the start of each day.
`analysis/`	The tables for analysis (section 17), one file per month, and `_state.json`, which records the last day added.
`users/`	Each trader's own sidebar order, folded groups and test dates.
`market/`, `alerts/`, `locks/`	Market levels from the feed, the alert log, and short-lived lock files.